SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-14 Wednesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price
90.65 USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-14 17:45:18 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-14 17:30:20 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily
674.0 yuan/mt
▼ -3.0 -0.44%
MTD avg **679.8**
As of Oct 14 · vs Oct 13

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 14

MMi 61% Port Spot Daily
656 yuan/wmt
▼ -1 -0.15%
MTD avg **660**

MMi 58% Port Spot Daily
617 yuan/wmt
▼ -2 -0.32%
MTD avg **622**

MMi 65% Port Spot Daily
820 yuan/wmt
▼ -1 -0.12%
MTD avg **824**

MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily
89.50 USD/dmt
— 0.00 0.00%
MTD avg **90.86**

MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily
108.35 USD/dmt
▼ -0.35 -0.32%
MTD avg **109.88**

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily
821.58 yuan/mt
▼ -3.22 -0.39%
MTD avg **823.19**
As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8

Key View

Port prices remain soft as seaborne brands stabilise; demand recovery still needs trading support

Domestic prices remained under pressure while some seaborne brand quotations stabilised. DCE most-traded closed at 674.0 yuan/mt, down 0.44%, and all eight Qingdao products fell 2 yuan/wmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices eased to 656, 617 and 820 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% index held at USD 89.50/dmt and the 65% fell to 108.35. Meanwhile, nine of the 12 brand quotations rose and three were unchanged, showing that composite indices and individual brands do not always move together in the short term.

Marginal changes in demand warrant attention. Surveyed daily hot metal output was 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from Oct 7: the decline narrowed but output had not recovered. The second coke cut and lower freight may ease costs, yet additional mill buying still depends on orders and margin repair. Average import trading margins narrowed to 8.40 yuan/mt, also showing that lower costs may not fully offset selling-price pressure.

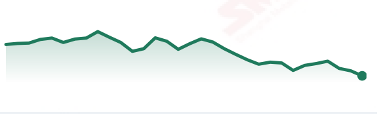
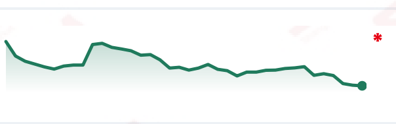
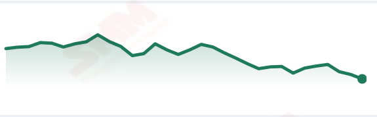
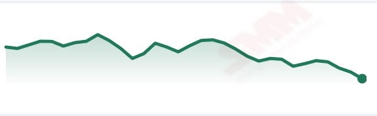
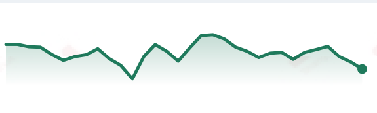
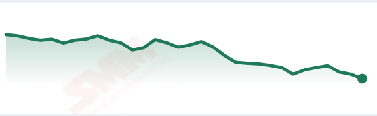
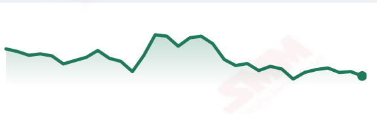
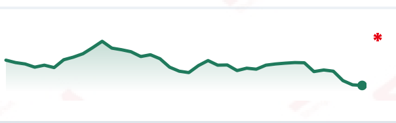
Firmer offers should be distinguished from a recovery in physical demand. Without sustained improvement in port transactions and mill restocking, strength in some seaborne brands may struggle to lift the broader market. Stabilising hot metal and stronger buying could improve downside support. A soft, range-bound outlook remains appropriate while watching for aligned improvement in trading, production and inventories.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and port prices eased further.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **674.0 yuan/mt**, down 3.0 yuan (-0.44%) from Oct 13. All eight Qingdao spot products fell 2 yuan/wmt, with PB Fines at 643, Newman Fines 646, Mac Fines 647 and Carajas Fines 829.
- **The seaborne 61% index held steady while the 65% eased.** The MMi 61% index was unchanged at **USD 89.50/dmt**; the 65% was **108.35**, down 0.35 (-0.32%). Their spread narrowed to USD 18.85/dmt.
- **Brand quotations stabilised while port indices still fell.** Against the Oct 13 report, nine of the 12 seaborne brands rose and three were unchanged. PB Fines at USD 89.80/dmt, Newman Fines at 88.90 and Mac Fines at 89.25 were flat. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 617 and 820 yuan/wmt, down 1, 2 and 1 yuan.
- **The hot metal decline narrowed, but demand recovery remains in focus.** SMM's surveyed daily hot metal output was **2.3520 million mt** on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from Oct 7. The blast furnace operating rate fell 0.03 percentage point to 87.03%. Output continued to ease, leaving the purchasing response to cost relief important.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-14 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	643	▼ -2 -0.31%	648	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	646	▼ -2 -0.31%	651	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	647	▼ -2 -0.31%	650	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	693	▼ -2 -0.29%	698	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	838	▼ -2 -0.24%	843	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	505	▼ -2 -0.39%	510	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	829	▼ -2 -0.24%	830	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	829	▼ -2 -0.24%	838	 *

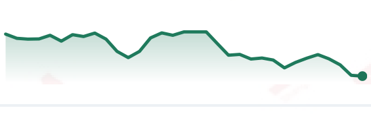
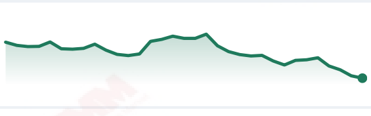
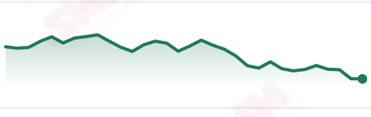
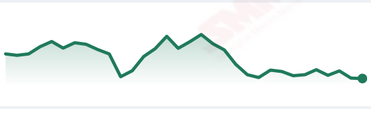
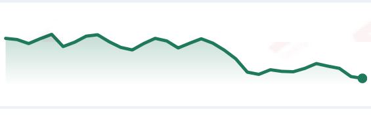
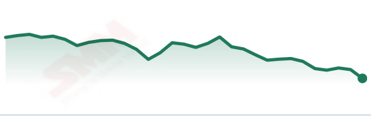
$ Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-14 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-13
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.20	▲ +0.05 +0.06%	86.15
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.90	▲ +0.05 +0.06%	87.85
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.80	— 0.00 0.00%	89.80
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.90	— 0.00 0.00%	88.90
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	89.25	— 0.00 0.00%	89.25
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.65	▲ +0.20 +0.23%	85.45
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.10	▲ +0.30 +0.29%	104.80
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	95.30	▲ +0.40 +0.42%	94.90
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	95.35	▲ +0.25 +0.26%	95.10
RTX Fines 61% Daily	84.75	▲ +0.15 +0.18%	84.60
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.30	▲ +0.05 +0.06%	89.25
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.25	▲ +0.35 +0.45%	77.90

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

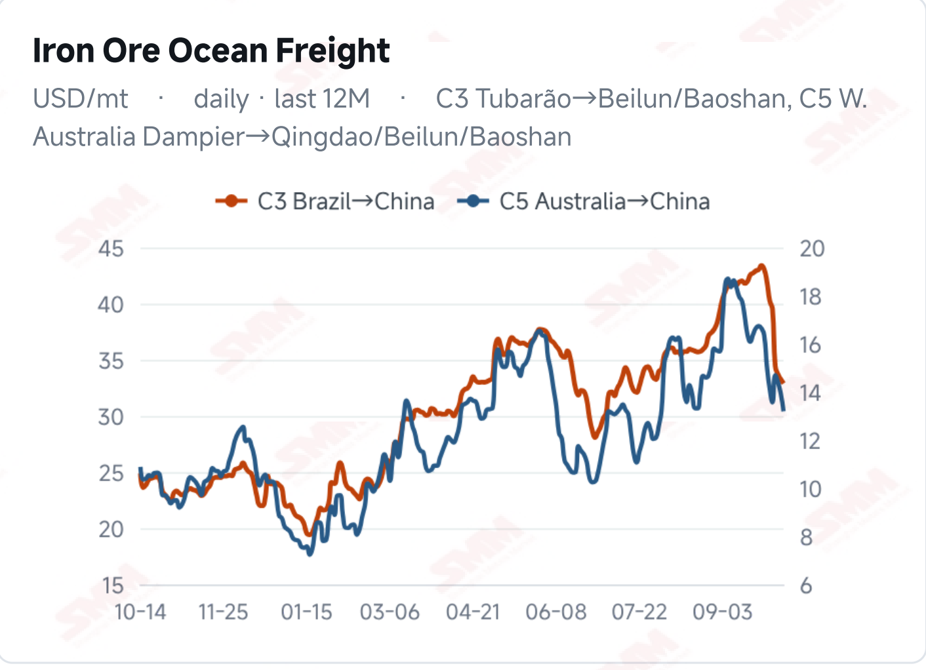
Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.86	-5.85%	-15.5%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	109.88	-3.98%	-10.7%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	660	-4.59%	-19.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	824	-1.84%	-8.8%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	622	-3.86%	-14.1%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	823.19	-1.83%	-7.3%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was unchanged at USD 89.50/dmt, while the 65% was 108.35 (-0.32%), narrowing their spread from USD 19.20 to 18.85/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 656, 617 and 820 yuan/wmt, down 1, 2 and 1 yuan from the previous readings.

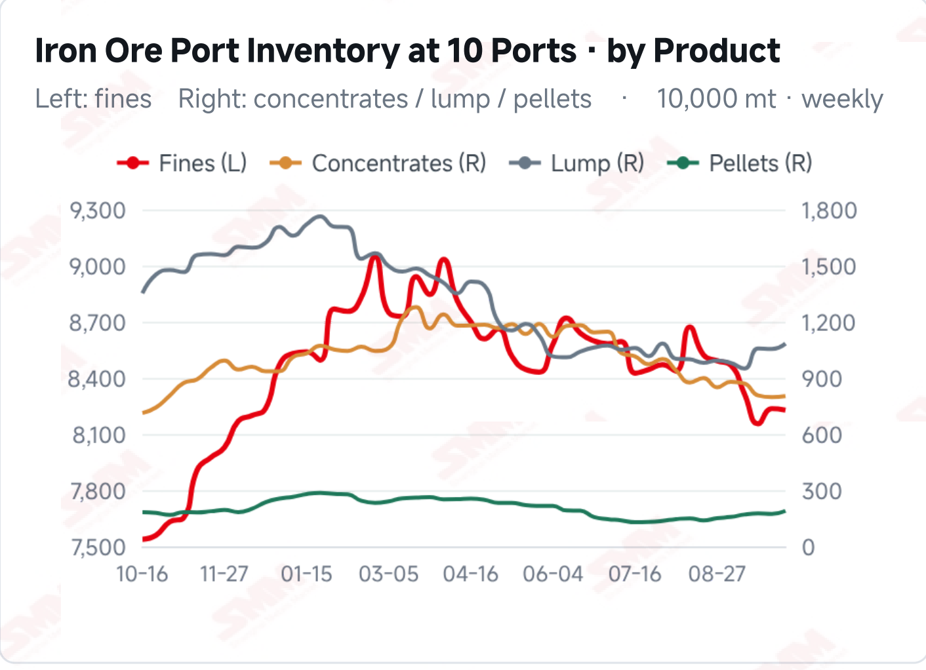
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

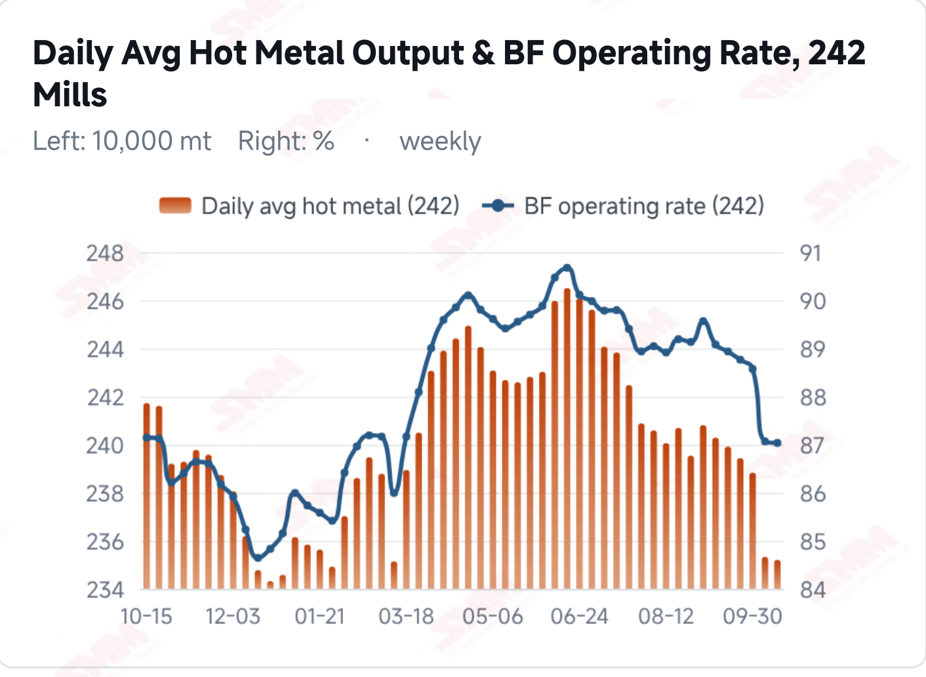
Last 12 months



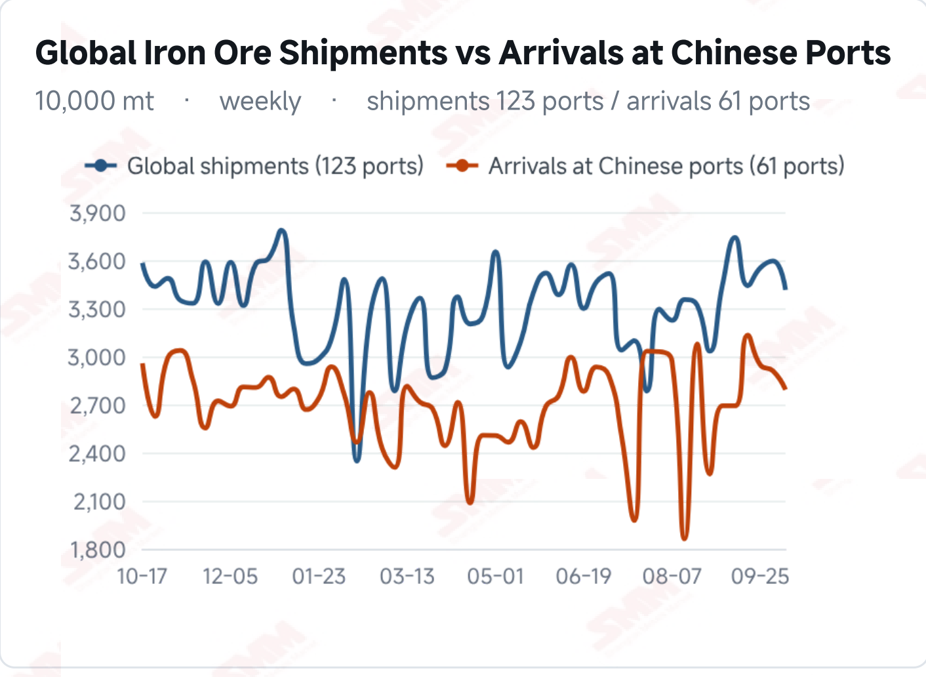
Iron Ore Ocean Freight
USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product
Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills
Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports
10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports

Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 674.0 yuan/mt, down 0.44% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 643, Newman Fines 646, Mac Fines 647, BRBF 693, Newman Lump 838, SSF 505, Carajas Fines 829 and PB Lump 829 yuan/wmt, all down 2 yuan. The latest price for SGX official current-month FEFV26 was USD 90.65/dmt, timestamped Oct 14, 17:30:20 (UTC+8).
Drivers	Domestic futures and composite port indices declined while seaborne brand quotations were mostly slightly higher or unchanged, showing continued short-term differences across markets. Firmer brand offers may reflect resource availability and buying schedules but do not establish a broad demand recovery. The spread between the composite seaborne 61% and 65% indices narrowed to USD 18.85/dmt; mill blending choices and actual transaction support remain important.
Demand	SMM's 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from 2.3532 million mt on Oct 7. The blast furnace operating rate fell 0.03 percentage point from 87.06% to 87.03%. The output decline narrowed from the previous period but had not turned into growth. Estimated maintenance-related losses of 1.9011 million mt for Oct 10–16 measure a different quantity from daily hot metal output. Limited improvement in end-user orders may keep mill purchases focused on immediate needs.
Inventory & supply	In the week to Oct 9, global shipments were 34.1393 million mt, down 5.02% WoW, while arrivals in China were 27.9147 million mt, down 4.05%. Brazil shipped 7.0226 million mt and Australia 19.5081 million mt. Lower supply flows may ease subsequent arrival pressure, but existing port stocks and mill collection schedules also matter. The latest available 10-port inventory was 103.0165 million mt as of Sep 30; shipment changes should not be equated directly with realised port destocking.
Cost & margin	SMM's Oct 14 imported ore cost-and-margin assessment put the period's average import margin at 8.40 yuan/mt, down 1.20 yuan from 9.60. This reflects import trading rather than steelmaking or coking profitability. Oct 13 freight was USD 32.88/mt for C3 and 13.19/mt for C5, down 1.14% and 5.24% from the previous reading. Lower transport costs may partly cushion weaker selling prices. The second coke cut has taken effect, while a third round remains under negotiation rather than providing realised cost relief.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	SMM's Oct 14 Liaodong brief described weekly quotations of 650–660 yuan/mt for 65% concentrates on a wet-basis, tax-exclusive ex-works basis. Some sellers reduced prices by 10 yuan/mt under mill pressure. The latest national Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 821.58 yuan/mt on Oct 9; region, grade and pricing terms distinguish these measures.
Supply & demand	Insufficient run-of-mine ore constrained efficiency at some Liaodong operations, while some sellers without funding or stock pressure preferred to hold material, offering price support. However, softer imported ore and mills' cost-control priorities kept bargaining pressure strong. Regional supply constraints coexist with cautious buying, making actual trading conditions more informative than individual quotations alone.
Outlook	SMM expects near-term Liaodong prices to remain range-bound. Conservative mill buying could limit a recovery, while continued local supply tightness may cushion declines. Domestic ore should be assessed by region and pricing basis rather than treating concessions by some sellers as a nationwide decline.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

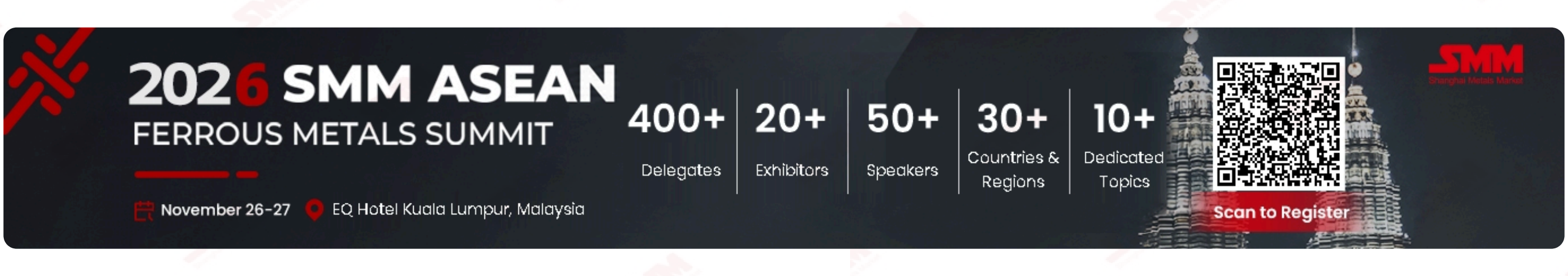
- Nine seaborne brand quotations rose and three were unchanged, with mainstream mid grades steady.
- The weekly hot metal decline narrowed to 1,200 mt.
- Latest shipments and arrivals both fell, potentially easing subsequent supply pressure.
- Freight declined further, cushioning costs for some cargoes.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE closed 0.44% lower and all eight port products fell 2 yuan.
- All three port indices declined and the seaborne 65% index fell 0.32%.
- Mill purchasing remains constrained by profitability and end-user demand.
- Average import margins narrowed to 8.40 yuan/mt, pressuring trading profitability.

Flash News

- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrates prices in the Liaodong region may consolidate ↗
  2026-10-14
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261014 ↗
  2026-10-14
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Prices Remain Firm as Mill Maintenance Raises Supply Concerns ↗
  2026-10-14
- [SMM Steel] India's Steel Prices Show Mixed Trends Amid Limited Buying ↗
  2026-10-14
- [SMM Steel] European HRC: Balanced Supply and Demand as Duty and Currency Risks Narrow Import Margins ↗
  2026-10-14
- [SMM Steel] Turkish Billet: Black Sea Bottlenecks and Delays Empower Local Mills to Hike Prices and Fill Supply Deficit ↗
  2026-10-14



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